

Money & Finance

54 words · Money & Finance

NOUNS

debt

money owed to another person, company, or institution

She graduated with over thirty thousand euros of debt.

income

money received regularly from work, investments, or benefits

Her monthly income barely covers the rent and bills.

budget

a plan for how money will be spent over a period

We need to stick to a strict budget this month.

tax

money paid to the government from income, purchases, or property

Income tax rates vary depending on how much you earn.

interest rate

the percentage charged by a bank for borrowing money, or paid on savings

The central bank raised interest rates to combat inflation.

recession

a period of significant economic decline

The country entered a deep recession after the financial crisis.

disposable income

the money a person has left after paying taxes and essential costs

With rising rents, young people have very little disposable income.

savings

money set aside and not spent, usually kept in a bank

He used his savings to put a deposit on a flat.

mortgage

a long-term loan used to buy a property

They took out a thirty-year mortgage on the house.

bill

a written statement of charges for goods or services

The electricity bill was much higher than expected.

inflation

a general increase in prices and fall in the purchasing value of money

Inflation has pushed the cost of groceries up by fifteen per cent.

investment

money put into something with the expectation of future profit

Property is still seen as a safe long-term investment.

expenditure

the total amount of money spent over a period

Government expenditure on healthcare has doubled in ten years.

ADJECTIVES

affordable

cheap enough for most people to buy

Housing in the city centre is no longer affordable for young people.

broke

having no money at all (informal)

I can't come out tonight. I'm completely broke.

overpriced

costing more than it is worth

The restaurant was overpriced and the food was mediocre.

exorbitant

unreasonably and shockingly high in price

The rent in central London is exorbitant.

frugal

spending money very carefully and avoiding waste

She's naturally frugal. She never buys anything she doesn't need.

VERBS

earn

to receive money in return for work or services

She earns a good salary but spends most of it on rent.

owe

to be required to pay money to someone

He still owes me fifty euros from last month.

squander

to waste money or resources carelessly

He squandered his inheritance in less than two years.

afford

to have enough money to pay for something

They can't afford to go on holiday this year.

splurge

to spend a lot of money on something enjoyable, often without much thought

I don't normally buy expensive shoes, but I splurged on a pair for the wedding.

scrimp and save

to spend very little money and avoid waste in order to save up for something

They scrimped and saved for years to afford the deposit.

PHRASAL VERBS

save up

to gradually accumulate money for a specific purpose

She's saving up for a trip to Japan.

pay back

to return money that was borrowed

I'll pay you back on Friday, I promise.

cut back on

to reduce spending or consumption of something

We've had to cut back on eating out since the bills went up.

rip off

to charge someone far too much for something (informal)

Twenty euros for a coffee? We got completely ripped off.

bail out

to rescue a person or organisation from financial difficulty

The government bailed out the banks during the crisis.

pay off

to finish paying a debt in full

It took her five years to pay off her student loan.

get by

to manage to survive or live on very little money

It's tough, but we get by on what we earn.

put aside

to save money regularly for future use

She puts aside two hundred euros a month for emergencies.

splash out

to spend a lot of money on something, especially a treat

He splashed out on a weekend in Paris for her birthday.

COLLOCATIONS

cost a fortune

to be extremely expensive

The repairs cost a fortune, nearly three thousand euros.

small print

the detailed conditions of a contract or agreement, often containing important restrictions

He didn't check the small print and ended up paying a huge cancellation fee.

IDIOMS

make ends meet

to have just enough money to cover basic living expenses

Many families are struggling to make ends meet.

tighten your belt

to spend less money because you have less available

With the new baby, they've had to tighten their belts.

cost an arm and a leg

to be extremely expensive

The hotel was beautiful but it cost an arm and a leg.

in the red

in debt, especially as shown by a negative bank or business balance

The business was in the red for most of its first year.

gone through the roof

increased dramatically

Everything's gone through the roof. The weekly shop costs a fortune now.

throw money down the drain

to waste money on something worthless

Paying for that gym membership was throwing money down the drain.

pocket money

a small regular sum of money given to a child by a parent

She gets ten pounds pocket money a week, and she has to save half of it.

live from hand to mouth

to spend all your money on immediate needs with nothing left over

After losing his job, he was living from hand to mouth for months.

money doesn't grow on trees

used to say that money is limited and should not be wasted

I can't buy you everything. Money doesn't grow on trees.

break the bank

to be very expensive; to use up all your money

A weekend away doesn't have to break the bank.

burns a hole in your pocket

makes you want to spend money immediately rather than save it

A spender, unfortunately. Money burns a hole in my pocket.

a nest egg

a sum of money saved for the future

She built up a comfortable nest egg over the years.

SET PHRASES

give or take

used after a number or amount to show that it is approximate, not exact

The repairs ended up costing about three hundred pounds, give or take.

the odds are

used to say that something is likely to happen or be true

The odds are you'll pay less if you book the tickets a few months early.

on balance

taking everything relevant into account, overall

Should we book the cheap flight with the long layover, or pay more? On balance, I'd pay more.

MODERN SLANG

quid

a pound, in British currency (informal; used for both singular and plural)

Could you lend me twenty quid until payday?

a rip-off

something that is outrageously overpriced

Eight euros for a coffee? What a rip-off.

skint

having no money at all (British informal)

I can't come out tonight. I'm completely skint.

loaded

extremely wealthy

Her grandad's loaded, apparently, but he still drives a twenty-year-old car.